CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 15

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She wants to take two courses that conflict.
- She doesn't understand a foreign language.
- She wants to transfer out of Honours Psychology.
- She doesn't want to take first year Latin.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She thinks it would be too difficult.
- She has had enough French.
- She doesn't think it should be required.
- She wants to take it in her second year.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- The General and Honours courses are the same.
- They are more difficult than the second year courses.
- Not very many students want to register for them.
- They are required only for Psychology students.

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- A plus
- A
- A minus
- lower than A minus

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- not being part of any social group
- not getting grades as high as her friend
- not becoming an Honours student until third year
- not having friends in the General program

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- denial
- agreement
- shock
- shame

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- Latin
- French
- English
- Chinese

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- happy
- confused
- surprising
- sad

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a few minutes
- ◯ several weeks
- ◯ a month
- ◯ a long time

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She will be late for a meeting.
- ◯ She will miss her lunch date.
- ◯ The man is asking too many questions.
- ◯ Her boss will be upset.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ in the same apartment complex
- ◯ in the same townhouse complex
- ◯ on the same street
- ◯ on the same residential block

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She regularly takes the bus.
- ◯ It's too cold to walk.
- ◯ Her car is being serviced.
- ◯ Her car isn't working today.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ They share a taxi.
- ◯ The bus arrives.
- ◯ Her car is fixed.
- ◯ A friend picks them up.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Her sister recommended the company.
- ◯ She saw their advertisements online.
- ◯ They have received awards.
- ◯ They help find a good location.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ Her sister is a professional flower arranger.
- ◯ They aren't planning to have flowers.
- ◯ The flowers arrangements are expensive.
- ◯ The woman works in a flower store.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because it will be lower cost
- ◯ because the event will be outside
- ◯ so people can choose their food
- ◯ so people can choose their table

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She wants to please everyone.
- ◯ Her sister wants vegetarian food.
- ◯ Some guests are allergic to seafood.
- ◯ Some of her family dislike vegetarian food.

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She asks for more information.
- ◯ She books the company right there.
- ◯ She decides to continue looking.
- ◯ She will check with her husband.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ birthday party
- ◯ retirement party
- ◯ wedding anniversary
- ◯ wedding reception

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Ron and Sally went for _____
- ◯ a drive in the mountains.
- ◯ a long hike in the mountains.
- ◯ a picnic in the mountains.
- ◯ a helicopter ride in the mountains.

2. The Jacksons _____
- ◯ intended to be away only for the afternoon.
- ◯ were not noticed by local residents.
- ◯ did not bring any food and water with them.
- ◯ intended to camp at the top of the mountain.

3. The Jacksons got lost _____
- ◯ when it started to get dark.
- ◯ when they left the trail in the forest.
- ◯ because their car broke down.
- ◯ because they got dehydrated and confused.

4. A rescue operation began after _____
- ◯ the Jacksons called the police by cell phone.
- ◯ a friend realized they had not returned.
- ◯ someone noticed their parked car had not moved.
- ◯ a local resident saw the Jackson's camp fire.

5. The Jacksons survived by _____
- ◯ relying on the supplies they had brought.
- ◯ finding things to eat in the forest.
- ◯ building a shelter next to the creek.
- ◯ using smoke as a call for help.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. Which word best finishes the man's last sentence? "If everyone weren't so . . .
- ◯ busy
- ◯ pessimistic
- ◯ self-centered
- ◯ unfriendly

2. Why do the women remain silent at the end of the video?
- ◯ They're amused that the man is describing himself.
- ◯ The man has given them headaches.
- ◯ They still disagree with what the man said.
- ◯ They don't understand what the man said.

3. What are the co-workers meeting to discuss?
- ◯ whether to hold an event this year
- ◯ the format for an annual event
- ◯ whether to hire experts for an event
- ◯ the changes to next year's event

4. What is the topic of the annual lecture?
- ◯ acceptable workplace behaviour
- ◯ improving your people skills
- ◯ managing your time on the job
- ◯ the role of the legal departmen

5. What is the man's attitude toward the event?
- ◯ He would rather not make a presentation.
- ◯ He wishes the women weren't involved.
- ◯ He would rather resolve staff grievances.
- ◯ He wants to invest time in other priorities.

6. What do the women think about the lecture format?
- ◯ It's too confusing.
- ◯ It's too lengthy.
- ◯ It's too passive.
- ◯ It's too technical.

PART 5

7. What room does the woman in the T-shirt want to reserve?

- ◯ the one they're in now
- ◯ a room with a stage
- ◯ the staff cafeteria
- ◯ a big meeting room

8. Why does the woman in the T-shirt mention the winter party?

- ◯ to warn of the risks of tribal thinking
- ◯ to suggest it should be in summer
- ◯ to illustrate a need for improvement
- ◯ to give an example of inclusiveness

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. Roger's son _____

- ◯ works in the same city as Roger did.
- ◯ takes the same bus as Roger did.
- ◯ lives in a more distant suburb than Roger did.
- ◯ has a more comfortable commute than Roger did.

2. City planners in Canada have _____

- ◯ managed to reduce traffic congestion in the suburbs.
- ◯ neglected the building of roads for the suburbs.
- ◯ struggled with insufficient funding for bridges and roads.
- ◯ failed to reduce commute times for most drivers.

3. The speaker argues that an alternative planning policy should be to _____

- ◯ build wider roads and increase the number of bridges.
- ◯ persuade people to use the transit system.
- ◯ encourage people to work from home.
- ◯ build more major access roads to the suburbs.

4. In Vancouver, many people opposed _____

- ◯ more bridges near the city.
- ◯ a bicycle lane on a bridge.
- ◯ wider roads in the suburbs.
- ◯ more train stations in the suburbs.

5. One problem with public transit is that _____

- ◯ the cost of public transport is not competitive.
- ◯ trains are often quite dirty and unhygienic.
- ◯ there are not enough buses to meet demand.
- ◯ shopping centres are more easily accessible by car.

6. The speaker believes that _____

- ◯ current city planning policies are bound to fail.
- ◯ roads being built will reduce congestion.
- ◯ public transit systems are too slow.
- ◯ budget for road expansions should increase.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	She wants to take two courses that conflict.
Question 2	She has had enough French.
Question 3	The General and Honours courses are the same.
Question 4	A plus
Question 5	not being part of any social group
Question 6	denial
Question 7	Chinese
Question 8	happy

PART 2	
Question 1	a few minutes
Question 2	She will be late for a meeting.
Question 3	on the same street
Question 4	Her car isn't working today.
Question 5	They share a taxi.

PART 3	
Question 1	They have received awards.
Question 2	The woman works in a flower store.
Question 3	because the event will be outside
Question 4	She wants to please everyone.
Question 5	She asks for more information.
Question 6	wedding reception

PART 4	
Question 1	a long hike in the mountains.
Question 2	intended to be away only for the afternoon.
Question 3	when they left the trail in the forest.
Question 4	someone noticed their parked car had not moved.
Question 5	finding things to eat in the forest.

PART 5	
Question 1	self-centered
Question 2	They're amused that the man is describing himself.
Question 3	the format for an annual event
Question 4	acceptable workplace behaviour
Question 5	He wants to invest time in other priorities.
Question 6	It's too passive.
Question 7	a big meeting room
Question 8	to illustrate a need for improvement

PART 6	
Question 1	works in the same city as Roger did.
Question 2	failed to reduce commute times for most drivers.
Question 3	persuade people to use the transit system.
Question 4	a bicycle lane on a bridge.
Question 5	shopping centres are more easily accessible by car.
Question 6	current city planning policies are bound to fail.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between two people in a university office. The woman is about to start university, and the man is a Student Advisor.

Section 1:

MAN: Hello, how can I help you?

WOMAN: I'm registered for the Honours Psychology program, and for the foreign language requirement, I'd like to take Latin, but it's offered at the same time as the first year Honours Psychology course.

MAN: You could take French instead.

WOMAN: But I took French in high school. Every single year.

MAN: Well, you could take the first year General Psychology course, and then just switch to the Honours courses in your second year. That way you could take Latin.

WOMAN: The first year Honours Psychology course isn't a prerequisite? For me?

MAN: Not really. We have so many students wanting first year Psychology, we just created two sections. And it makes sense to put all the Honours students in the one section and the General students in the other. You're already accepted into the Honours program, so there's no problem just registering for the Honours courses in your second year.

WOMAN: Okay, thank you.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. What is the woman's problem?
2. What does the woman think about taking French?
3. What does the man imply about the first year Psychology courses?

Section 2:

MAN: Hello again!

WOMAN: I was talking to a friend about what you advised, and she actually did that. But she said that once she was in second year, she never got anything higher than an A minus. Her professors thought she was just a General student trying to step up to the Honours level. Even though, like me, she was an A plus student all through high school.

MAN: I'm sorry to hear that. Many students' grades go down once they're in university. Perhaps your friends' high school teachers graded easy. I really don't think our professors would be so prejudiced. I'm sure they grade assignments fairly.

WOMAN: I hope you're right. Even so, I'd like to be considered an Honours student from the beginning. She also said that by second year, everyone's formed their groups. So she felt like an outsider in the Honours program for the rest of her degree.

MAN: I see. Well, there might be another solution. If you took a language course at the other university, you might get credit for it here. I'd have to look into that. In the meantime, why don't you see if they offer a Latin course, and bring back the course outline, in case the decision here is made on a case by case basis.

WOMAN: Okay, I'll do that.

Now answer questions 4-6.

4. What grades did the woman's friend get in high school?
5. What is the woman concerned about?
6. What is the man's response to the woman's implication about professors?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: Hello, I have good news—we give transfer credit for all language courses at the other university. Even English.

WOMAN: Oh, that is good news. They don't have Latin, but they do offer Chinese, which I'd like to take. And it doesn't conflict with any other of my first year courses.

MAN: Not even the Honours Psych?

WOMAN: No!

MAN: Then you're all set!

WOMAN: Yes!

Now answer questions 7-8.

7. What language course will the woman take?
8. How would you describe the ending?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation that takes place at a bus stop.

WOMAN: Hi! I'm waiting for the number #87 bus that goes by Main Street. Do you know if this is the right stop?

MAN: Yes, it is the right stop, but apparently we both just missed the bus! I'm just checking the transit schedule on my phone and it came by five minutes ago, even though it says it should be here right now. I guess it came early. The next one comes in half an hour.

WOMAN: Oh, darn. I'm going to be late to my business meeting. I would have driven to work today, but my car got a flat tire last night. I think I drove over a nail or something.

MAN: That's too bad. Is your car the red Honda parked on the side of Wordsworth Avenue?

WOMAN: Yes, it is!

MAN: We're neighbours then! I noticed a red Honda with a flat tire outside my house this morning.

WOMAN: I live up the street on the next block, but the tire rim was scraping on the ground and I didn't want to damage it. Is it okay if I park it in front of your house until I get it fixed?

MAN: Leave it as long as you like! Did you move here recently? I don't think I've seen you before.

WOMAN: One month exactly today! I used to live downtown, but I prefer it out here, where there's more nature.

MAN: I like living out here as well. The only real drawback is that commuting to the city takes a lot longer.

WOMAN: It would be okay, if only transit was reliable! I'm really late. Maybe I should just take a cab. Are you going to Main Street as well? Did you want to split a cab there?

MAN: That would be great, actually. I'm meeting a friend for lunch and I don't want to keep him waiting.

WOMAN: That works out perfectly then. I'll just call a cab now!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. How long have the man and woman known each other?
2. Why is the woman worried?
3. Where do the man and woman live?
4. Why is the woman taking the bus to work?
5. How do they get to Main Street?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation where a woman arranges an event.

WOMAN: Hi there, I saw that the Green Butler company won the award for best catering on bestweddings.com, so I thought I'd drop by. My family and I are planning my sister's wedding for July 9th.

MAN: We can certainly cater your event! We provide a comprehensive range of wedding services from location rentals to floral arrangements, and custom menu choices.

WOMAN: Well, I'm actually a florist myself, so we won't need flowers, thanks! And my sister has already picked Clearwater Park as her location, so that's covered too. But everything else we will need.

MAN: Excellent. How many people will be coming to your event?

WOMAN: We've invited seventy, and so far fifty have confirmed. Could I let you know the exact number by the end of next week?

MAN: Oh, no rush! As long as we know a week in advance to the actual day of the event, that'll be fine . . . Now, what sort of meal service would you prefer? We offer full multi-course dinners, buffet-style food, or appetizers on platters.

WOMAN: I think buffet-style would be best. It will be outdoors in the park, and we don't want to have to set up too many tables or chairs.

MAN: Great! We have four basic options for buffet menus. One is vegetarian, one is seafood, one is meat, and one is continental, which is basically a mix of the other three. Of course, we can modify them if needed.

WOMAN: Sophia and her fiancé are both vegetarian, but the rest of our families are not, so I think the continental menu would work best.

MAN: Sounds good! Would you like to book this today? We take a 25% deposit at the time of booking, and the rest of the payment no less than ten days before the event. If you should need to cancel, the pre-payments and deposits are forfeited.

WOMAN: That all sounds great. Send us a quote with full pricing details laid out, and we'll get back to you in a few days.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Why is the woman interested in this company?
2. What does the woman say about flowers?
3. Why does the woman want a buffet-style meal?
4. Why does the woman choose the continental menu?
5. What is the woman's final decision?
6. What kind of event is the woman planning?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about two people who got lost.

Two hikers lost on Mount Gibson for the past three days were finally found and rescued today. Ron and Sally Jackson left their home in Calgary, Alberta last Saturday and drove north to Mount Gibson. The couple had planned to spend the afternoon hiking the mountain trails and carried a small backpack containing only sandwiches and water. An hour into their hike, they decided to leave the designated trail and soon became lost in the dense forest. Fortunately, a local resident noticed that their car had been parked at the base of the mountain for a few days. He notified the police, and a Search and Rescue helicopter was sent to look for the pair.

When asked how they had managed to survive, Sally Jackson, who was uninjured but very dehydrated, answered, "We ate berries and drank water from the creek." Search and Rescue official Frank Smith said, "People should always carry extra food, water, and clothing when hiking, and they should also inform someone as to where they plan to hike and approximately when they expect to return."

Grateful for his rescue, Ron Jackson said, "We wouldn't be alive today without the help of the man who reported our car to the police and the experienced Rescue Crew that found us. And next time, we'll stick to the marked trails!"

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three colleagues at work. The man works in the company's Legal department, and the women work in the company's Human Resources department.

Beatrice: Thank you for meeting with us, Ted. We know how busy you are.

Ted: Yeah, too busy for this! Is this meeting even necessary? Every year we present the "Hostile Workplace" lecture. I talk about the legal issues; you guys talk about the personnel issues. What's to discuss? We could've picked a time, you could've booked the room . . . we wouldn't have to have this meeting.

Rosa: Hey, I'm short on time, too. But I want to make some changes to this year's event, so let's talk. First of all, no more standing on the stage while people just sit and listen.

Beatrice: We thought that the staff could be more actively involved . . . maybe do some roleplaying games.

Ted: There's over a hundred staff, and they all have to attend! Doing some kind of . . . participatory drama games . . . it's gonna be kind of chaotic, isn't it?

Beatrice: Well, I'm no expert, but roleplaying is a widely-used learning activity. People can learn a lot from it. And isn't that our goal? To help our employees learn? Teach them what to do and not to do on the job? This affects you directly, you know.

Ted: Well, when you put it that way, I do want to reduce the number of grievances and prevent lawsuits.

Rosa: And we could do it in small groups. And in a cozier place than the cafeteria. Obviously, this room would be too small. But maybe we could book a conference room.

Ted: Look. I've got a lot on my plate. I can put aside maybe one day a week to do this . . . I don't want to do Marketing one day, Accounting the next day . . . If we could just book, say, every Monday at 10 o'clock, and do a different department each week?

Rosa: Actually, I was thinking we could get units to mix and mingle. Have you ever noticed that at the annual winter party, people just tend to stick to their own departments? I think it would be good for the company if people weren't so . . . attached to their tribes. We should warm up to other people . . . become more aware of what they do.

Ted: You know, that might go a ways towards creating a less hostile work environment. If people learned some respect for those in other departments . . . If everyone didn't think they were the only ones with important work to do . . . If everyone weren't so . . .

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about city planning.

Back in the 1980's, Roger Wang lived in Surrey, British Columbia and commuted to work in Vancouver. The journey took him forty minutes. Over the last thirty years, city planners have been designing and investing in road improvements and transit systems. Now, thirty years later, Roger's son lives in Surrey and commutes to Vancouver just as his father did. The journey by car takes close to an hour. Despite the changes, traffic congestion has not improved.

City planners across Canada have been unsuccessfully fighting commuter congestion for decades. Despite wider freeways, computerized management systems and more transportation corridors, most cities are worse off than they were three decades ago. Experience has shown that building more roads simply leads to more traffic. Moreover, most Canadian cities cover a huge area and demand a lot of roads. The cost of developing such an infrastructure in the low density suburbs of our cities is immense. What can we do to defeat traffic congestion once and for all? The short answer is that we need to get people out of their cars. City planning policies need to consider alternatives to roads. As long as most commuters travel alone in a car, traffic congestion will remain a problem.

Change will not be easy. Opposition to changes in city planning policies are overwhelming. In Vancouver, closing down a single lane of a bridge for a bicycle lane met with furious opposition from motorists. Proposals for a gasoline tax to raise funds for public transportation also met with protest from motorists. Curiously, the one form of commuter infrastructure investment that meets with general approval is more road bridges and wider roads—precisely the policies that have consistently failed over the last few decades.

In short, we have a society that seems determined to persist with failed policies. There are four reasons why this might be the case. First, for most commuters, private vehicles are usually faster than public transportation. Second, there is the problem of getting to the workplace from the train station which may involve an additional ten-minute walk. Third, fatigue also discourages utilization of our public networks. Few people wish to start and end their day with an hour of standing in cramped conditions. Fourth, grocery shopping or other errands after work might be difficult.

It seems that people will continue to rely on private vehicles until this mode of transportation proves less pleasant than the alternatives. City planners, however, continue to invest hundreds of millions of dollars in a road infrastructure that makes the motorists' method of commuting marginally more tolerable than the alternatives.